

The 1-Hour Session Prep Checklist

Prep a whole session in under an hour. Set a timer, fill each box, stop when the hour is up.

How to use it: prep the first fifteen minutes of play in detail and sketch the rest. The opening scene is the only part you control, so make it sharp. Everything after that you improvise from a few strong notes.

SESSION #: _____ DATE: _____ TIME BUDGET: 60 min

1 - STRONG OPEN (15m)

Setup: _____

Trouble already happening: _____

First line I say out loud: _____

2 - THE WANT (5m)

The villain/problem wants: _____

3 - THREE BEATS (10m) (ingredients, not a plot)

- _____

- _____

- _____

4 - ONE FIGHT (15m)

Monsters + number: _____

Where: _____

Stat page refs: _____

5 - NAMES & FACES (10m)

Names: __ / __ / __ / __ / __

Quirks (x3): _____

6 - SAFETY NET (5m)

Last session ended with: _____

Players said they will: _____

If stuck, they can find: _____

From First-Time Dungeon Master by Cedric Darkstone. Free to copy and print for your own table.